

CMS.100: Assessment Guide for A1

The purpose of this assignment is to understand how every dataset—regardless of field—is the result of decisions that someone made; it is not something that is simply “discovered.” In this case, that someone is you! In terms of assessment, I read your work as a whole and I use the following criteria to explain how successful (or not) the paper was at describing these different dimensions. This is **not** a check-list for which there are certain points attributed to each section. For CI-H purposes, the 500 word guideline is a *floor*, not a ceiling, so exceeding the word guideline is fine (but falling short is not).

Dataset and gap. Onuoha’s project shows that the data we don’t collect says something about what we value. Your write-up should explain why the absence matters—not just that it exists—and describe how and why your dataset addresses this gap.

Protocol in practice. Your protocol was a preliminary plan, and the actual collection process rarely goes exactly to plan—this is not only fine but expected! However, in the final write-up, a reader should be able to understand how you actually collected the data and where you found difficulties and what you did to address this.

Data structure. Someone else should be able to open your file and use it, which means that you must provide a guide to understanding how the dataset is structured (e.g., what 0, NA, or blanks mean; what each variable represents). You can do so in the form of a separate document (as with an appendix) or within the text of your write-up.

Instrument and process. Every measuring instrument shapes what it records—what did yours capture and what did it miss? What kinds of decisions did you have to make in the collection process? Were there unexpected events and how did you manage them?

Claims. A dataset supports some claims and not others. What does your dataset show and how does the data support that claim? What are its limitations? Place this in broader historical or social context.

Visualization. The visualization is labeled, constructed, and presented in a way that supports or otherwise complements the claims you make in the write-up. The visualization contributes to your broader argument; it is not just a reiteration of the main point.

How these become a grade

- **A:** Each choice in the dataset (e.g., what counts as data, what is excluded) is deliberate and well-explained. The work presents an argument that is supported by the data and the account of how the dataset is constructed is reflective and well-reasoned. The visualization makes an argument that the prose could not do alone.
- **B:** The choices are sound and mostly explained; the claims are generally supported by the data. However, the reasoning is uneven and the write-up does not fully account for how the measurement instrument shaped the results or does not make a clear, complete argument.
- **C:** The write-up asserts things the protocol could not have captured; construction of dataset is incomplete or is not fully explained or reflected upon in the write-up.
- **Below C:** The dataset or write-up doesn’t follow the assignment instructions.